screen or fails to communicate with the Au thority or an emergency is reported, MRCCs or MRSCs in the area are responsible for initia ting a search for the ship in accordance with the rules laid down for the search and rescue service, including the involvement of other participating ships known to be in that particular area.

5 RADIO COMMUNICATION REQUIRED FOR THE SYSTEM, FREQUENCIES ON WHICH REPORTS SHOULD BE TRANSMITTED AND INFORMATION TO BE REPORTED

5.1 The radio communications equipment required for the system is that defined in the GMDSS for sea area A1.


5.2 Ships are required to maintain a continuous listening watch in the area and to report and take any action required by the maritime Authorities to reduce risks:

5.3 Common call and information channels:

on channel 16  call and distress

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SOURCE: MSC.139(76).pdf
take any action required by the maritime Authorities to reduce risks:

5.3 Common call and information channels:

on channel 16  call and distress

5.4 The full report can be made by voice on VHF radio using the following channels:

| | m a i n | r e s e r v e |
|---|---|---|
| HELSINKI TRAFFIC | 60 | 80 |
| TALLINN TRAFFIC | 61 | 81 |
| ST. PETERSBURG TRAFFIC | 74 | 10 |

5.5 Ship reports can, alternatively, be made by AIS, provided that the report can be transmitted fully.

5.6 Confidential information may be transmitted by other means.

5.7 The language used for communication shall be  English, using the IMO Standard Marine Communication Phrases, where necessary.

6 RELEVANT RULES AND REGULATIONS IN FORCE IN THE AREA OF THE SYSTEM

6.1 Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea

The International Regulations for Preventi ng Collisions at Sea are applicable throughout the reporting area.

6.2 Traffic Separation Schemes

The Traffic Separation Schemes in the Gulf of Finland have been adopted by IMO and rule 10 of the International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea applies.

6.3 Pilotage

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SOURCE: MSC.139(76).pdf
the reporting area.

6.2 Traffic Separation Schemes

The Traffic Separation Schemes in the Gulf of Finland have been adopted by IMO and rule 10 of the International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea applies.

6.3 Pilotage

Pilotage is mandatory in national waters under national laws.

6.4 Dangerous and hazardous cargoes

6.4.1 Ships carrying dangerous or hazardous cargoe s and bound to or from any port within the ship reporting area must comply with the inte rnational and national regulations. The ship reporting system does not relieve ships mast ers of their responsibility to give the nationally required reports and information to customs authorities.

6.4.2 Discharges of oil and ship-generated waste is monitored by the joint Estonian, Finnish and Russian Authorities. Ships causing pollution within the area can be prosecuted and fined.

RESOLUTION MSC.139(76)
(adopted on 5 December 2002)
MANDATORY SHIP REPORTING SYSTEMSMSC 76/23/Add.1
ANNEX 13
Page 8

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7 SHORE-BASED FACILITIES TO SUPPORT OPERATION OF THE SYSTEM

The joint Estonian, Finnish and Russian Aut horities have radar, information processing

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MANDATORY SHIP REPORTING SYSTEMSMSC 76/23/Add.1
ANNEX 13
Page 8

7 SHORE-BASED FACILITIES TO SUPPORT OPERATION OF THE SYSTEM

The joint Estonian, Finnish and Russian Aut horities have radar, information processing and retrieval system, radio VHF and Automatic Identification System (AIS) facilities. The frequencies used in AIS–NET are AIS1 and AIS2.

7.1 HELSINKI TRAFFIC

7.1.1 System capability

7.1.1.1 The control centre is situated at the Helsi nki VTS in Helsinki. The operator can control, monitor and display the status of all the VT S sensors from the consoles. The VTS centre will at all times be manned by two operators.

7.1.1.2 HELSINKI TRAFFIC maintains a continuous wa tch on traffic in the Gulf of Finland on channels 60 and 16. Operators add reported vessel information to the associated database and can display supporting information on the screen. The system is capable of providing an automatic alarm to identify any track which strays into an unauthorised area. Recording equipment automatically stores info rmation from all tracks, which can either

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SOURCE: MSC.139(76).pdf
an automatic alarm to identify any track which strays into an unauthorised area. Recording equipment automatically stores info rmation from all tracks, which can either be replayed in the system or from the recorded resource. Records are made by an authorized method that can be used as an evidence. Operators have access to different ship registers and hazardous cargo data.

7.1.2 Radar facilities

7.1.2.1 The surveillance sensors can observe target s of at least 300 gross tons and a minimum height of 10 metres in the given traffic area.

7.1.3 Radiocommunication facilities

7.1.3.1 Radiocommunication terminals are sited in the consoles of HELSINKI TRAFFIC operation room. VHF radio transceivers ar e located at Hanko, Porkkala, Harmaja, Emäsalo and Orrengrund.

The VHF channels used are:

Channel 60 working channel
Channel 80 reserve channel

7.1.4 AIS facilities

7.1.4.1 HELSINKI TRAFFIC can continually receive the messages broadcasted by ships fitted with transponders to gain information on thei r identity and position. This information is displayed as an icon on an electronic chart c overing the Gulf of Finland mandatory ship

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SOURCE: MSC.139(76).pdf
with transponders to gain information on thei r identity and position. This information is displayed as an icon on an electronic chart c overing the Gulf of Finland mandatory ship reporting area.

7.1.5 Personnel qualifications and training

7.1.5.1 HELSINKI TRAFFIC is staffed with pe rsonnel trained according to national and international recommendations.


7.1.5.2 The training of the personnel comprises an overall study of the navigation safety measures, the relevant international (IMO) a nd national provisions with respect to safety of navigation. The training al so includes thorough real-time simulations in different ship bridge simulators. The trainees are traine d as well in navigating ships through the VTS area as servicing shipping from the VTS Centre.